

Employee Handbook

Policies, Benefits & Ways of Working

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1. Welcome to NexaTech Solutions

This handbook applies to all NexaTech Solutions employees across our Seattle, Austin, New York, Toronto, London, Berlin, Bangalore, and Singapore offices, including remote and hybrid staff assigned to client engagements. It replaces version 6.1, issued March 2025, and reflects updated travel and remote-work provisions approved by the Executive Leadership Team in Q4 2025.

NexaTech Solutions was founded to help enterprise clients modernize their technology estates across cloud infrastructure, artificial intelligence, cyber security, data engineering, and enterprise applications. As of this revision, the firm employs approximately 550 people across eleven departments.

Nothing in this handbook constitutes a contract of employment. Where local law in a given office jurisdiction conflicts with a provision below, local law governs and HR Business Partners will advise on the applicable variance.

2. Employment Basics

2.1 Employment Classification

- Full-Time Regular — scheduled 40 hours/week (37.5 in the UK office), eligible for full benefits.
- Part-Time Regular — fewer than 30 hours/week, eligible for prorated benefits after 90 days.
- Fixed-Term Contractor — engaged through a statement of work with a defined end date; benefits per local statutory minimums only.
- Intern — typically 10–16 week rotations aligned to the Cloud Engineering, AI Solutions, or Data Engineering practices.

2.2 Probationary Period

New full-time employees complete a 90-day introductory period (180 days for the Bangalore and Singapore offices, consistent with local practice). Performance and fit are reviewed by the employee's manager no later than day 75 of the period.

2.3 Working Hours and Overtime

Core collaboration hours are 10:00 a.m.–3:00 p.m. in the employee's local office time zone. Employees on active client delivery engagements should also account for reasonable overlap with client business hours, which the assigned Project Manager will communicate at project kickoff. Non-exempt employees (primarily Customer Success coordinators and administrative staff) must record overtime in TimeTrack Pro prior to working it, except in client-emergency situations.

3. Remote & Hybrid Work Policy

NexaTech operates a hybrid-first model. Employees are expected to work from a NexaTech office or an approved client site a minimum of two days per week unless their role is designated fully remote by their Director. Fully remote designations must be renewed annually and are tracked in ResourceHub.

3.1 Home Office Stipend

Employees working hybrid or fully remote receive a one-time USD 750 (or local currency equivalent) home-office setup allowance during their first 60 days, plus an annual USD 200 connectivity stipend disbursed each January payroll cycle. Equipment purchased with the stipend remains company property and must be returned or repurchased at depreciated value upon termination.

3.2 Working Across Time Zones

Given NexaTech's presence across ten countries, cross-time-zone collaboration is routine. Employees are not expected to regularly attend meetings outside a 7:00 a.m.–7:00 p.m. local window except with prior manager approval, which should be the exception rather than the norm on any single engagement.

3.3 International Remote Work Requests

Employees wishing to work temporarily from a country other than their home office location must submit a request through NexaPortal at least 15 business days in advance. Requests exceeding 30 consecutive days require Finance and Legal sign-off due to tax-residency and immigration implications. As of the FY2026 policy update, such requests are capped at 60 days per rolling 12-month period.

4. Travel Policy

Client-facing roles frequently require travel; this section governs both client-site travel and internal (all-hands, training) travel.

4.1 Booking and Class of Travel

- All air travel must be booked through the corporate travel portal linked in NexaPortal; exceptions require Director approval and are reimbursed only up to the equivalent portal fare.
- Economy class for flights under 6 hours; Premium Economy for flights between 6 and 10 hours; Business class for flights exceeding 10 hours, or at Director discretion for red-eye departures the night before a client-facing engagement.
- Rail is preferred over short-haul air travel within Europe where the rail journey is under 3.5 hours (e.g., London–Paris, Berlin–Amsterdam).

4.2 Per Diem Rates

Region	Daily Meal Per Diem (Local Currency)	Lodging Cap (Nightly)
United States / Canada	\$75	\$275
United Kingdom	£55	£210
European Union	€60	€195
Singapore	S\$95	S\$320
India (domestic travel)	₹3,200	₹9,500

Per diem rates were last revised effective October 1, 2025 to reflect inflation adjustments; expense reports submitted for travel prior to that date should reference the prior rate table archived in NexaPortal.

4.3 Expense Submission

Expenses must be submitted in ExpenseWise within 15 calendar days of trip completion, with itemized receipts attached for any single expense over \$25 (or local equivalent). Expenses submitted after 45 days require Finance Director approval and may be treated as taxable income per local payroll regulations.

5. Compensation & Benefits

5.1 Payroll

Employees are paid on a semi-monthly basis in the United States and Canada, monthly in the UK, Germany, Singapore, and India offices. Salary reviews occur annually in March, with off-cycle adjustments available for promotions processed at any point in the year.

5.2 Health, Dental & Vision

Full-time employees in the United States are eligible for medical, dental, and vision coverage beginning the first of the month following 30 days of employment; NexaTech covers 80% of the employee premium and 60% of dependent premiums under the PPO Gold plan. Employees in the UK, Germany, Singapore, Toronto, and Bangalore offices participate in country-specific plans coordinated by local HR Business Partners and summarized in the regional benefits addenda distributed at onboarding.

5.3 Retirement / Pension

US employees are eligible for the 401(k) plan with a 4% company match after 90 days, vesting immediately. Canadian employees participate in a Group RRSP with a 3% match. UK employees are auto-enrolled into the NexaTech workplace pension per The Pensions Regulator requirements.

5.4 Paid Time Off

Office / Region	Annual PTO Accrual	Public Holidays	Notes
United States	18 days (accrued monthly)	10	Unused PTO up to 5 days carries into the following year
Canada	20 days	9 (Ontario) / varies by province	Statutory minimum plus 5 discretionary days
United Kingdom	25 days	8	Excludes statutory bank holidays, tracked separately
Germany	28 days	varies by Bundesland	Statutory minimum under BUrlG is 20 days for a 5-day week; NexaTech provides above minimum
Singapore	18 days	11	Prorated for employees with under 2 years' tenure per the Employment Act
India (Bangalore)	21 days + 12 casual/sick	varies	Includes festival holiday calendar published annually

5.5 Parental Leave

NexaTech provides 16 weeks of fully paid primary-caregiver leave and 6 weeks of fully paid secondary-caregiver leave globally, topping up any statutory government leave scheme to full salary. This policy was harmonized globally in July 2024; prior to that date, US employees were covered under a shorter 12-week primary leave policy, and some legacy offer letters still reference the older figure — HR Business Partners should confirm the current policy applies regardless of offer letter language.

6. Information Security & Acceptable Use

Every employee handling client data is bound by the Master Client Confidentiality Agreement referenced in their offer letter, in addition to the provisions below.

6.1 Data Classification

- Public — approved for external release (marketing material, published case studies).
- Internal Use Only — the default classification for handbook-style documents, internal status reports, and org charts.
- Confidential — client deliverables, architecture documents, and anything under an NDA.
- Restricted — client PII/PHI, financial account data, and credentials; subject to the Cyber Security team's Restricted Data Handling Standard (see Technology Standards, Section 9).

6.2 Credentials & Multi-Factor Authentication

All employees authenticate to internal systems via Okta single sign-on with mandatory multi-factor authentication. Shared credentials are prohibited without exception; SOC audits during 2025 flagged three instances of shared service-account credentials on client engagements, which prompted the rollout of HashiCorp Vault-backed secrets management described in the Technology Standards document.

6.3 Incident Reporting

Suspected security incidents — phishing attempts, lost devices, suspected unauthorized access — must be reported to security-incidents@nexatechsolutions.com or via the NexaHelp IT Service Desk within 1 hour of discovery. The Cyber Security Security Operations Center, led out of the London and Bangalore offices, maintains 24x7 monitoring coverage.'

7. IT Asset Policy

7.1 Standard Issue Equipment

New employees receive a company laptop (MacBook Pro for engineering and design roles, or a Windows ThinkPad for enterprise applications and finance roles), a docking station for hybrid staff, and a mobile device stipend of \$40/month for employees whose role requires business use of a personal phone.

7.2 Asset Return

All company-issued hardware must be returned within 10 business days of the employee's last day, using the prepaid shipping label generated automatically in NexaHelp. Employees who do not return equipment within 30 days may have the depreciated replacement cost deducted from final pay where permitted by local law.

8. Communication Policy

Slack (via the NexaTag integration) is the default synchronous internal channel; email is reserved for client-facing and formal internal communications. Employees should not use personal messaging apps to discuss client work product under any circumstances.

Department-wide announcements are distributed through NexaPortal and, for time-sensitive items, via the #company-announcements Slack channel. HR announcements referenced throughout this handbook — including promotion cycles and policy updates — are compiled quarterly in the HR Announcements bulletin.

9. Performance Management

Formal performance reviews occur twice yearly (April and October). Managers document goals and outcomes in SkillMatrix, which also tracks certification progress referenced in individual employee records maintained by the People Operations team.

10. Code of Conduct & Anti-Harassment

NexaTech maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, discrimination, or retaliation based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected under applicable law. Concerns may be raised confidentially with an HR Business Partner, through the anonymous ethics line operated by a third-party administrator, or directly with a Director.

Conflicts of interest — including outside employment, financial interests in current clients or vendors, and close personal relationships within a reporting line — must be disclosed to HR via NexaPortal's annual disclosure form. Managers may not directly supervise a spouse, domestic partner, or immediate family member without an approved alternate reporting arrangement.

11. Learning & Professional Development

NexaTech reimburses one job-relevant certification exam per employee per year (e.g., AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, CISSP, PMP) upon passing, and maintains an internal catalog of instructor-led and self-paced courses in NexaLearn. Directors nominate high performers annually for the Emerging Leaders Program, a nine-month rotational leadership track that has produced several of the firm's current Engineering Managers.

Conference attendance (e.g., AWS re:Invent, KubeCon, Black Hat) is budgeted at the department level; employees should discuss nominations with their manager during the annual planning cycle each September.

11.1 Internal Mobility

Employees who have been in their current role at least 12 months may apply to internal postings on NexaPortal without prior manager notification, consistent with our internal mobility philosophy. Department transfers approved through this process are recorded and periodically summarized in HR Announcements.

12. Leave of Absence

In addition to statutory leave (jury duty, bereavement, military service per USERRA and equivalent local statutes), NexaTech offers up to 12 weeks of unpaid personal leave for employees with over 2 years of tenure, subject to Director approval and a documented return-to-work plan coordinated with HR.

13. Termination & Offboarding

Voluntary resignations should be submitted in writing to the employee's manager with a minimum of 2 weeks' notice (4 weeks for Manager-level and above, to allow for client transition planning). Involuntary separations follow the performance-improvement and documentation process maintained by HR Business Partners and, where applicable, local statutory notice and severance requirements. Final pay, including accrued but unused PTO where required by local law, is issued on the next regular payroll cycle or per jurisdictional requirements, whichever is sooner.

Exiting employees complete an exit interview with HR and return all IT assets per Section 7.2. Access to client systems is revoked by the Cyber Security team within 4 hours of the last-day timestamp recorded in Workday.

14. Acknowledgment

Employees acknowledge receipt of this handbook electronically through NexaPortal during onboarding, and are prompted to re-acknowledge material policy changes such as this version's remote-work and parental-leave updates.